ENGLISH STUDIO / PHASE 1

Study materials

Full reading packets and the complete analysis content

Reading & Writing · B2 level · Complete source-based lesson set

INSIDE THIS PDF

- Six complete reading passages
- Content outlines and main ideas
- Vocabulary lists with English usage and Vietnamese notes
- Sentence patterns, discourse notes, and comprehension traps

Prepared from the current Phase 1 content used in the English Studio app.

PACKET 01 · Remote Work

The Benefits and Challenges of Remote Work

Graded text – Stage 1 | Remote Work

Reading passage

Remote work has become much more common since 2020. Many companies now allow employees to work from home instead of coming to the office every day. For a large number of people, this change has brought clear advantages. However, remote work also creates some real difficulties.

One of the biggest benefits is flexibility. Remote workers can often choose when and where they work. They do not need to spend time commuting, so they save both time and money. Many people also say that working from home helps them achieve a better work-life balance. They can spend more time with their family or take short breaks during the day.

At the same time, remote work has important challenges. Some employees feel isolation because they miss daily conversations with colleagues. Junior staff may also lose opportunities for informal learning — the kind of learning that happens naturally when people work together in the same place. Another problem is the difficulty of separating work from personal life. Without a clear end to the working day, some people continue checking emails late at night and feel stressed.

Success in remote work depends largely on self-discipline. Workers need to create a regular schedule, set clear boundaries, and stay focused. Companies can help by offering good communication tools and encouraging staff to take real breaks.

In short, remote work offers valuable flexibility and better balance for many people, but it also requires careful management of isolation and work boundaries.

Content map

• Chủ đề lớn: Remote work

• Mục đích: Explain both sides (advantages + disadvantages)

• Dàn ý:

• Remote work became popular after 2020

• Main benefits: flexibility, no commuting, better work-life balance

• Main challenges: isolation, hard to separate work and life, less informal learning

• Conclusion: success depends on self-discipline

Main ideas & logic

• Remote work means working from home instead of going to an office.

• One big advantage is flexibility – people can choose when and where to work.

• Another advantage is saving time because they do not need to commute.

• Many people also enjoy a better work-life balance.

• However, some workers feel isolated and lonely.

• Junior staff may learn less from colleagues (informal learning decreases).

• People need strong self-discipline to work effectively at home.

Vocabulary in context

Term	Meaning in the text	Collocation / use
remote work	working from home Vietnamese: làm việc từ xa / làm việc tại nhà	do remote work, remote workers
flexibility	ability to choose time and place Vietnamese: sự linh hoạt (chọn giờ, chọn nơi làm việc)	increase flexibility
commuting	travelling to work every day Vietnamese: việc đi lại giữa nhà và nơi làm việc	time spent commuting, reduce commuting
work-life balance	balance between job and personal life Vietnamese: sự cân bằng giữa công việc và cuộc sống cá nhân	improve work-life balance
isolation	feeling alone Vietnamese: sự cô lập, cảm giác bị tách biệt	feel isolation, social isolation
informal learning	learning from daily talk with colleagues Vietnamese: việc học hỏi tự nhiên từ đồng nghiệp	weaken informal learning
self-discipline	ability to control yourself Vietnamese: tính tự giác, khả năng tự quản lý bản thân	need strong self-discipline

Useful sentence patterns

• can + V; however, it may + V

• One of the main advantages of + N is that…

• It is important to + V

• As a result, …

Discourse & writer stance

• Linking words: however, another, in addition, as a result

• Stance: balanced

• Reference: “this” = remote work; “these problems” = isolation + less informal learning

Common comprehension traps

• Nghĩ tác giả phản đối remote work

• Hiểu nhầm flexibility = được làm việc ít

• Bỏ qua ý informal learning

• Nghĩ isolation chỉ xảy ra với người sống một mình

PACKET 02 · Why Learning English is Important

Why Learning English is Still Important Today

Graded text – Stage 1 | Why Learning English is Important

Reading passage

English is often called a global language, and for good reason. Around 1.5 billion people speak it, either as a first or second language. In today's world, knowing English continues to open many doors in education, work, and daily life.

First, English is extremely useful for education. Many of the best universities teach in English, and a large number of academic books and research papers are published in this language. Students who can read and write English well have more opportunities to study abroad and access high-quality learning materials.

Second, English creates better career opportunities. International companies often require employees who can communicate in English. People who are bilingual usually have more job choices and sometimes higher salaries. English also helps professionals work with colleagues and clients from different countries.

Another important reason is the internet. More than half of all websites use English. People who understand English can access information, watch videos, and join online communities much more easily. Without English, access to a huge amount of knowledge becomes limited.

Of course, learning English takes time and effort. However, the benefits are clear. Whether you want to study, build a career, or simply understand the modern world better, English remains one of the most useful skills you can develop.

Content map

• English is a global language

• Benefits for education and career

• English and the internet

• Conclusion: English opens many opportunities

Main ideas & logic

• English is used in many countries for communication.

• It helps students study abroad.

• It creates better career opportunities.

• Most information on the internet is in English.

• People who know English can communicate with the world more easily.

Vocabulary in context

Term	Meaning in the text	Collocation / use
global language	language used by many countries Vietnamese: ngôn ngữ toàn cầu	English is a global language
study abroad	study in another country Vietnamese: du học	opportunity to study abroad
career opportunities	chances to get good jobs Vietnamese: cơ hội nghề nghiệp	create more career opportunities
access information	get and use information Vietnamese: biết hai ngôn ngữ	bilingual employees
communicate effectively	speak and write so others understand clearly Vietnamese: tiếp cận thông tin	access information easily
bilingual	able to speak two languages Vietnamese: giao tiếp hiệu quả	communicate effectively with others

Useful sentence patterns

• One of the most important reasons why… is that…

• Not only… but also…

• As a result, …

• By learning English, you can…

Discourse & writer stance

• Stance: positive and persuasive

• Linking: firstly, in addition, moreover, as a result

Common comprehension traps

• Nghĩ tiếng Anh chỉ cần để đi du lịch

• Bỏ qua vai trò của internet

• Nghĩ văn bản nói tiếng Anh rất dễ học

• Nghĩ chỉ người bản ngữ mới cần giỏi English

PACKET 03 · Plastic Pollution

The Growing Problem of Plastic Pollution

Graded environmental text | Plastic Pollution

Reading passage

Plastic is one of the most useful materials ever invented. It is light, strong, and cheap. We use it in packaging, bottles, bags, and thousands of everyday products. Unfortunately, the same qualities that make plastic useful also make it a serious environmental problem.

The biggest issue is that plastic takes hundreds of years to break down. A plastic bottle thrown away today may still exist in the environment long after we are gone. Every year, millions of tons of plastic waste enter rivers and oceans. Scientists estimate that about eight million tons of plastic reach the sea annually.

This pollution harms marine animals. Sea turtles, fish, and birds often mistake plastic for food. When they eat it, the plastic can block their stomachs and cause them to starve. Other animals become trapped in plastic bags or fishing nets and die.

A large part of the problem comes from single-use plastic — items that are used only once and then thrown away, such as shopping bags, straws, and food packaging. Although recycling helps, it is not enough on its own. Many plastic items are never recycled.

The good news is that ordinary people can make a difference. We can reduce the amount of plastic we use, reuse containers whenever possible, and recycle correctly. Small changes in daily habits, when made by millions of people, can significantly reduce plastic pollution.

Content map

• Plastic is useful but causes serious pollution

• Single-use plastic is a major problem

• Plastic harms marine animals and the environment

• Solutions: reduce, reuse, recycle

Main ideas & logic

• Plastic takes hundreds of years to break down.

• Every year millions of tons of plastic enter the ocean.

• Animals often eat plastic by mistake.

• Single-use plastic (bags, bottles, packaging) is the biggest problem.

• People can help by using less plastic and recycling more.

Vocabulary in context

Term	Meaning in the text	Collocation / use
plastic pollution	pollution caused by plastic waste Vietnamese: ô nhiễm nhựa	reduce plastic pollution
single-use plastic	plastic used only once Vietnamese: nhựa dùng một lần	avoid single-use plastic
break down / decompose	slowly disappear naturally Vietnamese: phân hủy	take hundreds of years to break down
marine animals	animals that live in the sea Vietnamese: động vật biển	harm marine animals
reduce – reuse – recycle	three ways to solve the problem Vietnamese: giảm thiểu – tái sử dụng – tái chế	reduce, reuse and recycle
wildlife	animals and plants in nature Vietnamese: động thực vật hoang dã	protect wildlife

Useful sentence patterns

• Although plastic is useful, …

• One of the biggest problems is that…

• It is necessary to…

• As a result, …

Discourse & writer stance

• Stance: cảnh báo + kêu gọi hành động

• Linking: however, as a result, in addition, therefore

Common comprehension traps

• Nghĩ chỉ cần tái chế là đủ

• Bỏ qua single-use plastic

• Nghĩ ô nhiễm nhựa chỉ xảy ra ở biển

• Nghĩ vấn đề không liên quan đến cá nhân

PACKET 04 · Remote Work (Bài thật)

How Remote Work Brings Benefits and Challenges

Engoo (Intermediate) | Remote Work (Bài thật)

Reading passage

A recent survey of three thousand remote workers around the world found that 98 percent want to continue working remotely at least part of the time. It is not hard to see why. Remote work offers clear benefits: people can set their own working hours, save time and money on commuting, and enjoy more flexibility in their daily lives. For people with disabilities, working from home can also remove many practical difficulties of office life.

However, remote work is not perfect for everyone. Many workers struggle with loneliness. One in three said they stay at home too much because they have no reason to go out, and 23 percent reported feeling lonely. Another major challenge is separating work from personal life. In an office, the working day has a clear beginning and end. At home, the boundaries are much less clear. The same survey found that 81 percent of remote workers check emails after hours, and almost half often work outside traditional hours. Over time, this can lead to stress and burnout.

Even with these challenges, many people still believe remote work is worth it. The key is good management of time and boundaries. Experts recommend keeping a set schedule, avoiding work messages after hours, and taking regular breaks. When these habits are in place, remote work can offer both freedom and a healthy balance.

Content map

• Remote work rất phổ biến, 98% người muốn tiếp tục

• Lợi ích: tự chọn giờ làm, tiết kiệm thời gian & tiền đi lại, phù hợp người khuyết tật

• Thách thức: cô đơn, khó tách biệt công việc – cuộc sống cá nhân, dễ burnout

• Kết luận: vẫn đáng giá nếu biết giữ ranh giới rõ ràng

Main ideas & logic

• Hầu hết người làm remote muốn duy trì hình thức này.

• Lợi ích lớn: linh hoạt thời gian + không phải đi làm.

• Vấn đề lớn nhất: cảm giác cô đơn và ở nhà quá nhiều.

• Nhiều người vẫn kiểm tra email ngoài giờ làm việc.

• Cần giữ lịch trình cố định và không làm việc quá giờ.

Vocabulary in context

Term	Meaning in the text	Collocation / use
set your own working hours	decide when to start and finish work Vietnamese: tự quyết định giờ làm việc	set your own working hours
loneliness	feeling of being alone Vietnamese: sự cô đơn	struggle with loneliness
separate work from personal life	keep job and private life apart Vietnamese: tách biệt công việc và cuộc sống cá nhân	hard to separate work from personal life
burnout	extreme tiredness from too much work Vietnamese: ngoài giờ làm việc	check emails after hours
keep a set schedule	follow fixed working times Vietnamese: kiệt sức vì làm việc quá nhiều	cause burnout
after hours	outside normal working time Vietnamese: duy trì lịch trình cố định	keep a set schedule

Useful sentence patterns

• It’s not hard to see why…

• However, … is not perfect for everyone

• To avoid… it is important to…

• Even with its challenges, …

Discourse & writer stance

• Stance: balanced

• Linking: however, another, even with, to avoid

Common comprehension traps

• Nghĩ ai cũng thích remote work tuyệt đối

• Bỏ qua vấn đề burnout

• Hiểu nhầm flexibility = làm việc ít hơn

• Nghĩ cô đơn chỉ xảy ra với người hướng nội

PACKET 05 · Importance of English (Bài thật)

11 Reasons It's Important to Learn English

FluentU | Importance of English (Bài thật)

Reading passage

English is the most widely spoken language in the world when both native and non-native speakers are counted — about 1.5 billion people. This fact alone shows why learning English remains so important.

One of the strongest reasons is career opportunity. In the global job market, many international companies look for employees who can speak English. Bilingual people often have more job choices and can earn higher salaries. English also allows professionals to work with teams and clients from different countries.

Education is another major benefit. A large number of top universities teach in English, and most academic research is published in this language. Students who know English can study abroad more easily and access a much wider range of learning materials.

The internet makes English even more valuable. More than half of all websites are in English. People who understand the language can access information, watch educational videos, and join global conversations without barriers.

English is also useful for travel and cultural understanding. It helps people communicate in many countries and learn about different cultures and histories. Whether you are just beginning or already at intermediate level, improving your English continues to bring practical advantages in modern life.

Content map

• English is the most spoken language in the world

• Useful for jobs, travel, internet and culture

• Opens career and education opportunities

• Helps people connect globally

Main ideas & logic

• About 1.5 billion people speak English.

• English is the top language of the internet.

• Many international companies require English.

• Learning English can improve career prospects and earning potential.

• It also helps people understand world history and culture.

Vocabulary in context

Term	Meaning in the text	Collocation / use
the most spoken language	language with the most speakers Vietnamese: ngôn ngữ được nói nhiều nhất	English is the most spoken language
global job market	international employment opportunities Vietnamese: thị trường việc làm toàn cầu	succeed in the global job market
bilingual	speaking two languages Vietnamese: biết hai thứ tiếng	bilingual employees
earning potential	ability to earn more money Vietnamese: khả năng kiếm được thu nhập cao hơn	increase earning potential
access information	get knowledge and data Vietnamese: tiếp cận thông tin	access information online

Useful sentence patterns

• Whether you are… or…

• By learning English, you could…

• English is the top language of…

• One important reason is that…

Discourse & writer stance

• Stance: rất tích cực, thuyết phục

• Linking: first, moreover, in addition, another reason

Common comprehension traps

• Nghĩ chỉ cần tiếng Anh để đi du lịch

• Bỏ qua vai trò internet và công việc

• Nghĩ chỉ người trẻ mới cần học

• Nghĩ tiếng Anh không ảnh hưởng đến thu nhập

PACKET 06 · Plastic Pollution (Bài thật)

The World's Plastic Pollution Crisis Explained

National Geographic Education | Plastic Pollution (Bài thật)

Reading passage

Plastic is a relatively new material, but its impact on the planet has been enormous. Half of all the plastic ever produced was made in the last fifteen years. Production has grown so quickly that life without plastic is hard to imagine. Yet this rapid growth has created a global pollution crisis.

Every year, approximately eight million tons of plastic waste enter the oceans from coastal countries. Once in the environment, plastic can take hundreds of years to break down. Even when it does break down, it becomes microplastics — tiny pieces that remain in water, soil, and even the food chain.

Marine animals suffer the most visible harm. Many species eat plastic because they mistake it for food. Others become trapped in plastic bags, bottles, or discarded fishing nets. Scientists have found plastic in the stomachs of sea turtles, whales, and seabirds around the world.

A major part of the problem is single-use plastic — items designed to be used once and then thrown away. Although recycling is helpful, a large percentage of plastic is never recycled. Experts agree that the most effective solution combines three actions: reduce the amount of plastic we use, reuse items whenever possible, and improve recycling systems.

Plastic pollution is a global problem, but individual actions still matter. When millions of people choose to use less single-use plastic, the overall impact becomes significant.

Content map

• Plastic production has grown enormously

• A huge amount of plastic ends up in the ocean

• It harms animals and ecosystems

• Solutions require global effort and individual action

Main ideas & logic

• Half of all plastic ever made was produced in the last 15 years.

• About 8 million tons of plastic enter the oceans every year.

• Animals mistake plastic for food or become trapped in it.

• Plastic can take hundreds of years to break down.

• Reducing single-use plastic and improving recycling are essential.

Vocabulary in context

Term	Meaning in the text	Collocation / use
plastic pollution	the problem of plastic waste in nature Vietnamese: cuộc khủng hoảng ô nhiễm nhựa	tackle plastic pollution
single-use plastic	items used once then thrown away Vietnamese: nhựa sử dụng một lần	ban single-use plastic
break down	slowly disappear Vietnamese: phân hủy	take centuries to break down
marine life / wildlife	animals in the sea / in nature Vietnamese: vi nhựa (mảnh nhựa rất nhỏ)	microplastics in the ocean
microplastics	very small pieces of plastic Vietnamese: tích tụ, tích lũy	plastic accumulates in the environment
accumulate	gradually increase in amount Vietnamese: sinh vật biển / động thực vật hoang dã	harm marine life

Useful sentence patterns

• Although plastic has many uses, …

• One of the most serious consequences is that…

• It is estimated that…

• In order to solve this problem, we need to…

Discourse & writer stance

• Stance: serious warning + call for action

• Linking: however, as a result, in addition, therefore

Common comprehension traps

• Nghĩ vấn đề chỉ xảy ra ở các nước nghèo

• Nghĩ tái chế giải quyết được tất cả

• Bỏ qua vai trò của single-use plastic

• Nghĩ cá nhân không thể tạo khác biệt